

LAURA SOFIA RIVERA SANCHEZ



University of Toronto

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto

PhD: political science

(Expected 2028)

MA: political science

Sept. 2022 - June 2023

Concordia University

BA: Honours political science

Sept. 2020 - April 2022

McGill University

BSc: Honours mathematics and Minor in physics

Sept. 2016 - April 2020

CONFERENCES

American Political Science Association (APSA)

Sept. 2026

“In the Absence of Migrants:

Affective traces in transit rural communities” – *Panelist*

International Migration Research Network (IMISCOE)

July 2026

“Conceptualising Transit Communities: An affective milieu of
absence ↔ presence, foreigners ↔ locals,

illegality ↔ legality & periphery ↔ centre” – *Panelist*

Harney Program Symposium - Barriers & Borders:

March 2026

“When Irregularised Migration Moves– and When It Doesn’t: :

Reflecting on Methods for Tracing Affect in Transit Communities ” – *Panelist*

Prairie Political Science Association (PPSA)

Sept. 2025

“From Unemployment to Housing Affordability:

Immigration & the economy in Canadian immigration politics & policy” – *Panelist*

Latin American Political Science Association (LASA)

June 2024

“Affective Journeys: irregularized migrants and socioeconomic

interactions with border towns prior to the Darién Gap” – *Panelist*

Latin American Studies Network of Montreal (RELAM)

May 2022

“Clientelism in Chávez’s Venezuela: The Client’s Perspective” – *Panelist*

Fourth Space Concordia University

Sept. 2021

“Migration and Financial Inclusion: Tracking Migrant Remittances
in North America” – *Presenter*

RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

FIELD WORK

Border towns of Tulcán in Ecuador and Ipiales in

June 2024

Colombia (*Two weeks*)

Border towns of Acandí and Necoclí in Colombia (*One month*)

August 2023

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

University of Toronto

Bridging Divides Team Researcher with Dr. Phil Triadafilopoulos

May 2025 - Present

Mixed methods research / Migration and Canadian politics

Assistant of research for Dr. Martha Balaguera: <i>Mixed methods research - irregularised and trans migrations in Central America</i>	2024 - 2025
Université de Montréal Assistant of research for Dr. Ersy Contogouris: <i>Qualitative research - post-colonial and feminist movements in Latin America</i>	Fall 2022
Concordia University Assistant of research for Dr. Alexandra O. Zeitz: <i>Quantitative research - python models for API data extraction: migrant remittances</i>	Sept. 2021- May 2022

FELLOWSHIPS

Harney Program Graduate Fellowship - Munk School (<i>Graduate Student Fellow in Ethnic, Immigration, and Pluralism Studies</i>)	2025-2026
Inclusion and Governance in Latin America (ÉRIGAL) (<i>Undergraduate Student Fellow</i>)	Fall 2021

AWARDS

SSHRC Canada Graduate Research Scholarships – Doctoral (CGRS D)	2026-2028
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (OGS)	2025-2026
Desjardins Youth Scholarship	Fall 2024
Concordia Arts and Science Scholar Award Top 1% student in 2021-2022	Fall 2022
Desjardins Foundation Scholarship for Graduate Studies	Fall 2022
Desjardins Foundation Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies	Fall 2021
Concordia Undergraduate Student Research Award (CUSRA)	Summer 2021

TEACHING

University of Toronto	
POL305 - Intro to Latin American Politics & Societies <i>Teaching Assistant (TA)</i>	Fall 2025
POL360 - Topics in Latin American Politics <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2025
POL377A - Gender and the Politics of Development <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2025
POL378 - Cities and Citizenship <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2024
POL377B - Violence, Development, and Difference <i>Teaching Assistant (TA)</i>	Fall 2024
JPR374 - Religion and Power in the Postcolony <i>(TA)</i>	Fall 2024
POL219 - Institutions and Behavior in Comparative Perspective <i>(TA)</i>	Winter 2024
McGill University	
MATH 249 Honours Complex Variables <i>(grader)</i>	Fall 2020
MATH 248 - Honours Advanced Calculus <i>(grader)</i>	Fall 2019
MATH 458 - Honours Differential Geometry <i>(grader)</i>	Winter 2018
MATH 235 - Algebra I <i>(grader)</i>	Fall 2018; Fall 2019

LANGUAGES

French (C2) - Spanish (C2) - English (C2) - Portuguese (B1)

PLATFORMS

Microsoft Office, Python, Java, R, SQL, LaTeX, Google API, Stata

NON ACADEMIC WORK

Caisse de Dépôt et placement du Quebec

Intern: programmer of economic models on Python and SQL

Summer 2019; Jan-June 2020